

Economics Unit

For Grades 7, 8 & 9
ALIGNED TO THE AUSTRALIAN
CURRICULUM

TOPICS COVERED

**THE AUSTRALIAN
ECONOMY**

**OUR INTERCONNECTED
WORLD**

**GLOBALISATION &
SUPPLY CHAIN
MANAGEMENT**

ASSESSMENT

Unit Title: Australia's Global Connections

Unit Description

This unit covers new topics not covered previously. It will cover a broad range of topics such as:

- An introduction to economics
- The Australian economy - how it integrates within the broader global economy

During this unit students, will be required to work as individuals, in pairs and in groups and participate in several learning activities to cater and engage learners at differing levels. It is through these formative assessments within the unit that students can demonstrate their knowledge, learning and higher order thinking skills. These activities also give the teacher many opportunities to provide student feedback on how their learning and application of the content is developing. Several business cases are used throughout to increase students' depth of content knowledge and at the end of the unit students are required to develop the skills to analyse business cases to increase their understanding of how to apply the content to real life scenarios. .

By the end of this unit it is expected that students will understand how participants in the global economy interact as well as the responsibilities of participants in the workplace and why are these important in our globalised economy.

This unit is expected to form an important foundation for future economic and business learning and experiences.



Essential Learning

Australian Economics and Business Curriculum

Strand: Knowledge and Understanding

Content Descriptors:

Australia as a trading nation and its place within the rising economies of Asia and broader global economy (ACHEK038). Students will

- identify participants in the open Australian economy including household, business, finance, government and foreign sectors
- explain the objectives of the Australian economy to satisfy needs and wants through the production and distribution of goods and services
- identify Australia's major trading partners in the Asia region and the items of trade
- explain the impact of global events on the Australian economy and its trade and investment relations with other countries (for example, a natural disaster in a country of the Asia region)
- identify examples of global events that impact on economic activity (for example, environmental, financial, economic, political, technological, social, cultural, sporting events)

Why and how participants in the global economy are dependent on each other (ACHEK039). Students will

- explore Australia's interdependence with other economies and brainstorming the ways that consumers, producers, workers and governments interact with other economies
- locate a range of products in the local shopping centre that were produced overseas, and proposing reasons why they were not produced in Australia (for example, comparative advantage and gains from specialisation and trade)
- examine the implications of participating in an interdependent global economy for consumers, workers, businesses and government (for example, mapping the global supply chain for a product to identify the advantages and disadvantages for participants in the chain)
- investigate the activities of transnational corporations in supply chains and global business activities.

Aims:

The Australian Curriculum: Economics and Business aims to ensure students develop:

- understanding of the ways society allocates limited resources to satisfy needs and wants, and how they participate in the economy as consumers, workers and producers
- understanding of the work and business environments within the Australian economy and its interactions and relationships with the global economy, in particular the Asia region
- understandings that will enable them to actively and ethically participate in the local, national, regional and global economy as economically, financially and business-literate citizens
- reasoning and interpretation skills to apply economics and business concepts to make informed decisions

Rationale

Rationale

This unit is integral for students to understand the concepts of economics as well as the competitive and the ever-changing world that we live in. It is designed to increase students' knowledge and understanding of competition in the marketplace through questioning, research, interpretation, analysis, economic reasoning, decision making and application, communication and reflection. The learning experiences have been intentionally designed to extend and inspire learners using inquiry-based learning. Student learning will connect to practical situations with communication with a guest speaker offering knowledge and extending students deeper understanding about the topic.



Context

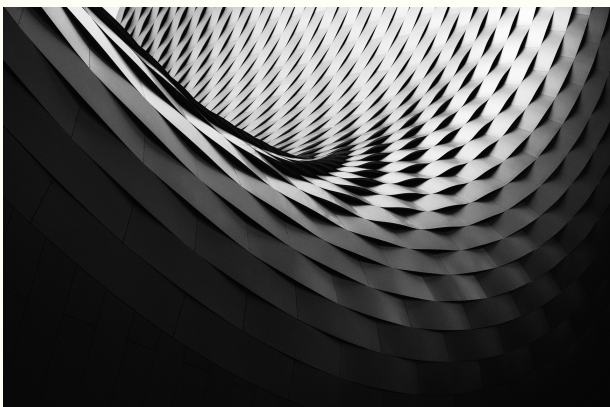
This unit has been designed for a Business Studies class.

It is introductory in nature as this is the first time that Business Studies has been offered to these students. It aims to achieve understanding of key business and economics concepts, structures and policies.

The unit titled “Australia’s Global Connections” can be taught at any time within a business studies class. At the end of the unit students will be required to sit a summative assessment examination.

Key Inquiry Questions

How do participants in the global economy interact?



Assessment Overview



Formative Assessment

Students will be observed on their engagement of the topic including responses to questions, involvement in discussions and participation in activities. A folio of work samples and homework completed will also be monitored with feedback provided. Specific formative assessments will include:

- Thinking Questions
- Rapid recall
- Worksheets
- Case study analysis
- Brainstorming

Summative Assessment

Student will sit a 60-minute exam with 10-minute perusal period at the end of the unit (worth 50 marks). This exam will consist of 15 multiple choice questions (worth 1 mark each), 5 short answer style questions (worth 3 marks each) and an extended response based on a case study (worth 20 marks). The short answer questions will cover content from the unit. Students will also be required to examine a hypothetical business case study and form an analytical extended response.

Assessment Objectives:

1. Identify participants in the economy
2. Identify Australia's major trading partners
3. Identify features and objectives of the Australian economy
4. Explain the impact of global events on the Australian economy in terms of trade and economic activity
5. Explain how participants in the global economy interact?
6. Explain the implications of participating in an interdependent global economy
7. Describe features of global supply chains

Curriculum Content



Australia's Global Connections

1. The Australian Economy

- What is economics?
 - Macro/Microeconomics
 - Economic Growth/Downturn
 - Introduction to Australia's Economy
 - Objectives of the Australian Economy
- Participants in the Australian Economy
 - Household Sector, Business Sector, Financial Sector, Government Sector

2. Our Interconnected World

- Australians as global citizens
- Point of Origin
- Economics in action
- Real world examples
- Foreign Trade
- The Australian Economy and Asia
- Global events and the Australian Economy (GFC)

3. Globalisation and Supply Chain Management

- What is Globalisation?
- Participants in the global economy
- Case Study – The Australian Car Industry
- How has Globalisation changed the Australian Car Industry?
- Positive and Negatives of Globalisation for Australia
- Global Supply Chains
- Supply Chain Management

ICT Integration & Resources

ICT integration

Students need to be able to participate in a knowledge-based economy and must be empowered the knowledge, skills and confidence to make ICT work for them at school, at home, at work and in their communities. ICT support the fast communication and representation of knowledge to many audiences in different contexts. Students will develop capability in using ICT for tasks associated within this unit on competing in the global marketplace by:

Teacher will:

- Utilise the interactive whiteboard for presentations to unpack content (all lessons)

Student will:

- Investigate elements of the global economy using technology
- Gather relevant data and information from a range of digital, online and print sources
- Define and plan information searches
- Use internet to research topic areas

Use multiple ICT resources including PowerPoint and YouTube

Teaching Resources

Powerpoint templates for activities

Youtube Clips to explain key concepts

Rapid recall

Quick Quiz

Worksheet – What is economics?

Case study analysis

Thinking Questions